

Andrea Calocero

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Marine Biologist | MSc Graduate | Looking for entry-level roles and Research Opportunities

PERSONAL STATEMENT

Recent MSc graduate in Marine Biology with a strong interest in marine conservation, biodiversity research, and ecosystem management. I have hands-on experience in wildlife conservation, biodiversity monitoring, environmental education, and field-based research through academic and conservation projects. My background combines ecological research, fieldwork, scientific data analysis, and public engagement. I am seeking opportunities in marine conservation and research where I can contribute to biodiversity protection while continuing to develop my scientific and field skills.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Postgraduate Research Intern - Polytechnic University of Marche – Ancona, Italy

February 2026 – Present

Supervisor: Prof. Roberto Danovaro

Taxonomic identification of marine nematodes collected from vegetated and unvegetated sediments associated with Adriatic seagrass ecosystems, as well as the assessment of trophic diversity and ecological status through the calculation of biodiversity metrics, the Maturity Index (MI), and the Index of Trophic Diversity (ITD). The research aims to compare community structure between habitats and identify the main environmental drivers shaping biodiversity patterns within the study area.

Sea Turtle conservation Intern – Blue Conservancy – Sea Turtle Rescue Centre (CRTM), Brancaleone, Italy

July 2024 – September 2024

Participated in sea turtle conservation, rehabilitation, and monitoring activities within one of Italy's main sea turtle rescue centres. Responsibilities included animal husbandry, assistance during veterinary procedures, rescue and release operations, biodiversity monitoring through BRUV surveys, and environmental education activities. I also coordinated volunteer groups (Sea Turtle Experience), delivered guided tours and conservation outreach sessions in Italian and English, led snorkeling activities, and contributed to public awareness campaigns addressing marine pollution, bycatch, overfishing, and biodiversity conservation.

Microbiology Laboratory Intern - UNISA – Fisciano, Italy

April 2022 – June 2022

Supported laboratory activities related to microbiological research, gaining practical experience in sample processing, laboratory procedures, scientific data collection, and microbiological techniques.

VOLUNTARY EXPERIENCE

Erasmus+ Project Participant – Youth Lead Local Development (YLLD)

2023

Participated in an international youth mobility project focused on leadership, intercultural exchange, and community development, collaborating with participants from different European countries and receiving the Youthpass certification (ID: SV75-5S7B-RDJN-V7PC).

Youth Educator and Volunteer

Parish Youth Centre S. Cecilia – Potenza, Italy

2013 – 2023

AGESCI Scoutism – Potenza, Italy

2008 – 2016

EDUCATION

MSc Marine Biology (110/110 cum laude) - UNIVPM – Ancona, Italy

2023 – 2026

Thesis: *Meiofaunal biodiversity in seagrass ecosystems of the Central Adriatic Sea (Gabicce Mare)*

Research conducted within the EU DIVERSEA Project under the supervision of **Prof. Roberto Danovaro** and **Prof. Cristina Gambi**. The study investigated biodiversity patterns of meiofaunal communities associated with *Zostera noltii*, *Zostera marina*, and *Cymodocea nodosa* meadows, comparing vegetated and unvegetated sediments and identifying the main environmental drivers influencing biodiversity across the study area.

BSc Biological Sciences (110/110) - UNISA – Fisciano, Italy

2019 – 2023

Thesis: *Staphylococcus aureus, the threat of antibiotic resistance and the potential solution from the sea*

SKILLS AND TRAINING

Technical Skills

Ecological field sampling • Marine nematode taxonomy • Meiofaunal analysis • Biodiversity monitoring • BRUV analysis • Scientific writing • Ecological data interpretation • R • QGIS • Microsoft Office Suite • Basic AI skills for scientific research support

Conservation & Field Skills

Wildlife monitoring • Sea turtle rehabilitation support • Environmental education • Public outreach • Volunteer coordination • Guided field activities • Science communication • Citizen science engagement

Professional Training

Project Management for Wildlife Conservation (WildTeam) (fully funded bursary, £190) • Monitoring and Evaluation for Wildlife Conservation (WildTeam) (fully funded bursary, £190) •

Marine Biological Data Management (IOC-UNESCO) • Marine Spatial Planning (IOC-UNESCO) • Coral Reef Management • Coral Reef Restoration • Sea Turtle Science & Conservation • Aquatic Mammals • Deep-Sea Fisheries Management Beyond National Jurisdiction (FAO) • Energy Efficient Ship Operation (IMO) • Marine Survey for Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA) – Reefera Academy • Introduction to Whale & Dolphin Identification ORCA (Organisation Cetacea)

INTERNATIONAL TRAINING

EUREMAP Summer School on Marine Bioprospecting

Marine@UGent – Ghent University, Ostend & Ghent, Belgium- 29th June – 3rd July 2026
Selected participant in the international EUREMAP Summer School on Marine Bioprospecting. Gained theoretical and practical training across the marine bioprospecting pipeline, including marine biotechnology, regulatory frameworks, research valorisation and intellectual property. Acquired hands-on laboratory experience in phenolic content analysis, R-phycoerythrin extraction and quantification, and siderophore detection (CAS assay), complemented by technical visits to leading marine research and biotechnology facilities.

CERTIFICATIONS

PADI Open Water Diver
Cambridge English Qualification (B2)

LANGUAGES

Italian: Native
English: Professional working proficiency (B2 Cambridge certified)
Spanish: Basic comprehension

AWARDS

Winner – 6th WWF Underwater Photography Competition ("Un Mare di Posidonia")
December 2025

INTERESTS

Marine conservation • Biodiversity monitoring • Marine Wildlife • Marine ecology • Underwater photography • Snorkeling and Scuba diving • Wildlife observation • Scientific communication • Marine research